

I picked an example email at random, and although I won't name the company to prevent me from getting sued, the email was for a company that is an "expert in AI services". How do we know that? Well duh, they say so 12 times in their email! What do they do? They take data, add intelligence, and then automate. Vague enough for you? They have tonnes of business knowledge and domain expertise. No really, just give them a call, and they will convince you of that fact. They assure you that they can make products that are not just AI automation, but which also learn constantly! (Quick! Someone notify the Nobel Prize committee, at least one 2018 prize is in the bag!). Now generously sprinkle on keywords such as cognitive, accelerated AI, knowledge, real-time learning, automated intelligence, contextual knowledge, leverage, and many more, and you have yourself an impressive sounding press release!

This is the state of AI today. It's trickery and fakery, and claiming to be smarter than it is, because we're only getting dumber anyway. It's the Turing test, but one where the humans are idiots, so the computer looks intelligent by default. This is so evident to me when I browse through social networks and find posts from people amazed at what is essentially simple coding.

The simplest example is all the "OMG how does Facebook know what I search for when I'm on other sites?" posts that people seem to keep making. Now you might already know that the answer is that Facebook doesn't know anything. It's merely using cookies, your IP address, and has tied up with ad networks that have tied up with other sites, which then make a nice little temporary file about you (or rather your IP + browser info). So when you search for, say, DDR4 RAM, and visit various seller's sites that have ad tracking and keyword

tracking, and view products related to that, you are tagged as someone searching for "DDR4 RAM". Now, when you're on Facebook, who is tied up with the same advertiser networks, you get DDR4 RAM ads, and even possibly the one you were looking at, even the same site you were looking at. Why? Because you are currency online. No one is interested in showing you ads, they want you to click and buy.

Facebook, like every other site out there, including us, wants you to click on an ad on our site and then go and complete a transaction. Such referrals earn us money, and money keeps our business alive and pays our salaries. So if you want to help Digit thrive, once you have decided to buy something



online, search for it on the Digit site, click the affiliate link that shows the price and site it's available at, and then buy it. Someone is going to get that money anyway. If you Google the product, that money goes to Google, and they have more than enough. Support us instead, OK?

Not "Smart"

Now that the shameless plug is done with, let's get back to these so called smart devices, or assistants, or robots, or cars, or whatever. They're not smart. Heck intelligence doesn't even apply to them.

They're code; written out rules. Far fancier ones than we've ever had before, admittedly, but lines of code nonetheless. It's the databases that have gotten much larger over the years. With so much more data being digitised all the time, especially the stuff that's in text, the "library" is growing to humongous proportions.

The world is already exchanging information in the zettabyte range. Approximately 20 zettabytes in 2017 according to some conservative sources – that's 20,000,000,000 TB (twenty billion terabytes)! Of course, this isn't the amount of data available, it's the amount of data transfer. Still if 20 ZB worth of data is being transferred, the total amount of data cannot be more than a few orders of magnitude lower. Some studies conducted by storage companies (which we will take with a small pinch of salt) claim that the actual data stored on all computers globally is about 20 ZB, and that by 2025, this could be as high as 160 ZB! Either way, let's just agree that these so-called smart systems have more data available to them than they need.

Let's say you wanted to search for a needle in a haystack, not proverbially, I mean literally, search for a needle in a haystack. Assuming the needle was hidden by me, you could do this intelligently: You could just set the haystack on fire, and once it's all burned away, the needle should be left. If you're not allowed to burn it, you could get a very powerful magnet and get the needle out that way... there are many ways in which it can be done. If you can't get a magnet, use a water trough, and shovel hay into it and spread it out on the surface. Hay floats, needles sink. Enough said.

These are intelligent human answers to such questions. Now, if someone you asked this question to said they would create a billion clones of themselves and each one